Fake Job & Recruitment Scams

Knowledge document for the AI Digital Safety & Scam Prevention Assistant

Safety rule: Verify a job, recruiter, and offer independently before sharing sensitive information or paying money. Never share an OTP, password, UPI PIN, or card security code with a recruiter.

1. What is a fake job scam?

A fake job or recruitment scam is an attempt to deceive a job seeker using a false vacancy, fake recruiter, impersonated company, fraudulent offer letter, or misleading hiring process. The scammer may try to collect money, identity documents, bank details, passwords, OTPs, or access to the victim's device.

2. Common warning signs

Upfront payment demands

Requests for registration fees, interview fees, refundable deposits, equipment fees, background-check payments, or money to release an offer. Treat unexpected payment demands as a major warning sign and independently verify any legitimate fee.

Unverified recruiter identity

The recruiter uses a personal or look-alike email address, an unverified phone number, a copied profile, or a name that cannot be confirmed through the company's official channels.

Guaranteed selection

Someone promises a job or offer without a credible assessment, or claims that payment guarantees selection.

Pressure and secrecy

The recruiter insists you pay immediately, discourages you from contacting the company, or threatens to cancel the offer if you take time to verify.

Suspicious offer letter

The letter contains mismatched company details, unusual grammar, inconsistent job titles, unverified signatures, or contact information that does not match official company information.

Sensitive information requests

The recruiter asks for OTPs, passwords, UPI PINs, card PINs, CVV, or remote access. These are not appropriate ways to verify a candidate.

Unsafe interview or onboarding links

The link asks you to install unknown software, download an APK, enter email or banking passwords, or grant remote-control permissions.

3. How to verify a job and recruiter

• Find the vacancy on the employer's official careers website. Do not rely only on a forwarded message, social-media post, or screenshot.

• Check the recruiter's email domain and compare it with contact details published on the company's official website. A matching display name alone is not proof.

• Contact the company using a phone number or email address obtained independently from its official website. Ask whether the recruiter, role, interview, and offer are genuine.

• Check whether the job title, location, salary, reporting manager, and hiring process are consistent across official communications.

• Inspect links before opening them. Do not enter passwords or banking credentials into pages reached through unverified messages.

• Do not pay under pressure. If a fee is claimed to be required, pause and verify the policy with the employer using official channels before taking any action.

• Share identity and education documents only when there is a verified, legitimate need and through a secure, official process. Avoid sending unnecessary sensitive information to unknown contacts.

4. Example scenarios

Scenario A: Registration fee. A recruiter says you are selected but must pay a fee today to reserve the job. **Safer response:** Do not rush or pay based on the message. Independently verify the vacancy and fee policy with the employer's official recruitment team.

Scenario B: Fake offer letter. You receive an offer letter from a free email address and are asked to pay for onboarding. **Safer response:** Verify the offer through the company's official contact details and careers portal before responding or sending money.

Scenario C: OTP request. Someone claiming to be HR asks for an OTP to validate your application. **Safer response:** Do not share the OTP. Stop the conversation and verify the recruiter through official channels.

Scenario D: Remote-access request. A recruiter asks you to install an unknown app or share your screen to complete an interview. **Safer response:** Do not install it or grant access until you have independently verified the process and software.

5. If you have already paid or shared information

• If you sent money, contact your bank or payment provider immediately. In India, report suspected financial cyber fraud by calling 1930 as soon as possible and follow the instructions to submit a report at https://cybercrime.gov.in/.

• Save the job post, email, offer letter, chat messages, phone numbers, URLs, payment receipts, transaction references, and timestamps.

• If you shared a password, change it through the genuine service's official website or app and change it anywhere else it was reused. Enable multi-factor authentication where available.

• If you shared identity documents, be alert for misuse and follow guidance from the relevant official service or authority. Do not share additional documents or credentials with the suspected scammer.

• Do not pay a further fee to someone promising guaranteed recovery of your money.

6. What the AI assistant can and cannot conclude

The assistant can identify warning signs and suggest independent verification steps. It cannot confirm that a recruiter, job vacancy, phone number, offer letter, or email is genuine based only on a description or screenshot. A professional-looking offer can still be fraudulent. Users should verify through official employer channels.

7. Reference sources to check

• **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal:** https://cybercrime.gov.in/

• **CERT-In Awareness Booklets:** https://www.cert-in.org.in/AwarenessBooklets.jsp

• **Employer's official careers website:** Use the official website address independently; do not rely on links sent by an unverified recruiter.

Maintenance note: Educational summary for a prototype knowledge base. Verify official reporting procedures and employer information independently. Last reviewed: 10 October 2026.